

KEY TOPIC 1: The End of the British Mandate & The Creation of Israel, 1945–1949

Lessons KT 1.0, KT 1.1 & KT 1.2 • Imperial Borders, UN Partition & The 1948–49 War of Creation

KEY TOPIC 1

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EXAM TERMINOLOGY VAULT:

Zionism

Balfour Declaration

British Mandate

Jewish Insurgency

UN Resolution 181

Al-Nakba

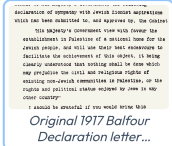
1949 Green Line Armistice

May 1916 – Nov 1917

ROOT CAUSES & IMPERIAL BETRAYAL

Imperial Contradictions: Sykes-Picot Agreement & The Balfour Declaration

- TRIGGER:**
- Britain sought wartime alliances, promising independence to Arab leaders (McMahon-Hussein) while secretly negotiating partition with France.
- ACTION:**
- Foreign Secretary Arthur Balfour committed Britain to supporting a "national home for the Jewish people" in Palestine without prejudicing existing civil rights.
- CONSEQUENCE:**
- Created an irreconcilable imperial conflict between Arab national self-determination and growing Jewish Zionist immigration under the League of Nations Mandate.



Original 1917 Balfour Declaration letter...

July 1946

JEWISH INSURGENCY & BRITISH EXHAUSTION

The Bombing of the King David Hotel, Jerusalem

- TRIGGER:**
- British restrictions on post-Holocaust Jewish immigration and the arrest of Zionist leaders (Operation Agatha).
- ACTION:**
- Militants from the Irgun (led by Menachem Begin) detonated milk churns packed with explosives in the basement, killing 91 British, Arab, and Jewish staff.
- CONSEQUENCE:**
- Shattered British political will to govern Palestine, leading directly to Foreign Secretary Ernest Bevin handing the Mandate to the United Nations in February 1947.



The collapsed south-west wing housing British...

July 1947

INTERNATIONAL PRESSURE & MORAL COLLAPSE

The SS Exodus & The Sergeants Affair

- TRIGGER:**
- The British Royal Navy blockaded Palestine, forcing 4,500 Holocaust survivors aboard the SS Exodus back to detention camps in post-war Germany.
- ACTION:**
- Irgun militants abducted and hanged two British intelligence sergeants (Paice and Martin) in retaliation for British executions of Irgun fighters.
- CONSEQUENCE:**
- Triggered anti-Jewish riots across British cities and convinced British public opinion that staying in Palestine was morally untenable and too costly.



The Sergeants Affair: Bodies of two executed...

29 November 1947

THE DIPLOMATIC CATALYST FOR WAR

UN Resolution 181: The Partition Plan

- TRIGGER:**
- UNSCOP investigated Palestine and concluded that joint Jewish-Arab power-sharing within a single state was impossible.
- ACTION:**
- The UN General Assembly voted to partition Palestine into independent Arab and Jewish states, placing Jerusalem under international UN trusteeship.
- CONSEQUENCE:**
- Jewish Agency accepted partition; Arab Higher Committee and Arab League rejected it outright, immediately triggering civil war between Jewish and Arab militias.



UN Resolution 181 map allocating 55% of Palesti...

14–15 May 1948

THE 1948 WAR OF SURVIVAL / INDEPENDENCE

Declaration of the State of Israel & Outbreak of the First Arab-Israeli War

- TRIGGER:**
- The final British High Commissioner departed Haifa, terminating the 26-year British Mandate.
- ACTION:**
- David Ben-Gurion read the Israeli Declaration of Independence; armies from five Arab nations (Egypt, Jordan, Syria, Iraq, Lebanon) invaded the next morning.
- CONSEQUENCE:**
- Haganah mobilized into the Israel Defense Forces (IDF); superior coordination, Czechoslovak arms, and motivation enabled Israel to survive and seize the initiative.



David Ben-Gurion declaring Israeli...

1948–1949

PERMANENT DISPLACEMENT & THE GREEN LINE

The Palestinian Nakba & The 1949 Armistice Green Line

- TRIGGER:**
- Intense military fighting, Plan Dalet clearing operations, and panic following massacres (e.g. Deir Yassin).
- ACTION:**
- Over 700,000 Palestinian Arabs were expelled or fled into exile in Gaza, the West Bank, Lebanon, Syria, and Jordan (known as *Al-Nakba*).
- CONSEQUENCE:**
- UN-brokered Armistice Agreements established the **Green Line**: Israel expanded from 55% to 78% of Palestine; Gaza held by Egypt; West Bank annexed by Jordan.



Palestinian refugees fleeing their ancestral...

KEY SPECIFICATION GLOSSARY:

Zionism: Political movement founded by Theodor Herzl advocating a sovereign Jewish homeland in Palestine.

Mandate: Administrative authority granted by the League of Nations to Britain to govern Palestine (1922–1948).

Al-Nakba: Arabic for "The Catastrophe": the expulsion and flight of 700,000+ Palestinians during the 1948 war.

Green Line: The 1949 armistice border separating Israel from Jordanian-held West Bank and Egyptian-held Gaza.

KEY TOPIC 2: Increased Tension, Crises and Conflict, 1955–1973

Lessons KT 1.3, KT 2.1, KT 2.2 & KT 2.3 • Suez Crisis, Six-Day War, Rise of Palestinian Resistance & Yom Kippur War

KEY TOPIC 2
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EXAM TERMINOLOGY VAULT:

- Pan-Arabism
- Suez Nationalisation
- Pre-emptive Strike
- Operation Focus
- UN Resolution 242
- Fedayeen
- Black September
- Bar Lev Line
- OPEC Oil Embargo

July – Nov 1956

ANTI-COLONIAL DEFIANCE & THE COLD WAR

The Suez Crisis & The Rise of Gamal Abdel Nasser

- TRIGGER: US and Britain cancelled funding for Egypt's Aswan High Dam after Nasser bought Soviet Czech weapons.
- ACTION: Nasser nationalised the Suez Canal; Britain, France, and Israel launched secret collusive invasion (Protocol of Sèvres).
- CONSEQUENCE: US President Eisenhower forced British and French withdrawal via economic threats; Nasser became the undisputed hero of **Pan-Arabism**; UNEF placed in Sinai.



President Gamal Abdel Nasser, hero of Pan-Ara...

5–10 June 1967

THE DECISIVE TERRITORIAL CATAclysm

The Six-Day War: Pre-emptive Triumph & Conquered Territories

- TRIGGER: Nasser expelled UNEF peacekeepers, remilitarised Sinai, closed Straits of Tiran, and signed joint defense pact with Jordan.
- ACTION: Israel launched **Operation Focus** pre-emptive air strikes, destroying Arab air forces in 3 hours, then crushed Egyptian, Jordanian, and Syrian ground armies.
- CONSEQUENCE: Israel captured the **Sinai Peninsula, Gaza Strip, West Bank, East Jerusalem, and Golan Heights**, placing 1 million Palestinians under military occupation.



David Rubinger's iconic photograph of Israeli...

22 November 1967

THE "LAND FOR PEACE" DOCTRINE

UN Security Council Resolution 242

- TRIGGER: International community scrambled to establish a durable legal formula to resolve the territorial outcome of the Six-Day War.
- ACTION: UNSC unanimously passed Resolution 242: called for Israeli withdrawal from occupied territories in exchange for Arab recognition and peace.
- CONSEQUENCE: Became the permanent diplomatic benchmark ("**Land for Peace**"); Arab League responded with the "**Three Noes**" of Khartoum (no peace, no recognition, no negotiation).



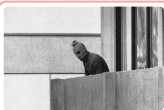
Map of the Conquered Territories establishing t...

September 1970

PALESTINIAN MILITANCY & THE PFLP

Black September: The Civil War in Jordan

- TRIGGER: The PLO and PFLP operated as a "state within a state" in Jordan, launching cross-border fedayeen raids and hijacking 4 Western airliners to Dawson's Field.
- ACTION: King Hussein ordered the Jordanian Army to crush Palestinian militia strongholds in Amman, killing thousands of fighters and civilians.
- CONSEQUENCE: The PLO leadership was expelled to Southern Lebanon ("Fatahland"); radical splinter group **Black September** formed, orchestrating the 1972 Munich Olympic massacre.



A Black September militant on the balcony a...

6–25 October 1973

SHATTERING ISRAELI COMPLACENCY

The Yom Kippur War: Operation Badr & The OPEC Oil Embargo

- TRIGGER: Egypt and Syria sought to break the diplomatic stalemate, erase the humiliation of 1967, and regain the Sinai and Golan Heights.
- ACTION: Launched surprise coordinated assault on the holiest Jewish day; Egyptian troops breached the Bar Lev Line under a Soviet SAM anti-aircraft umbrella.
- CONSEQUENCE: Shattered Israeli myth of military invincibility; Arab OPEC ministers launched an **Oil Embargo** quadrupling world oil prices; forced US into emergency shuttle diplomacy.



Egyptian infantry using high-pressure water...

KEY SPECIFICATION GLOSSARY:

- Pan-Arabism:** Ideology championed by Nasser promoting political, cultural, and military unity among all Arab nations.
- Pre-emptive Strike:** Military attack launched to forestall or neutralize an enemy's imminent offensive (e.g. Operation Focus 1967).
- Resolution 242:** UN resolution establishing "Land for Peace": Israeli withdrawal in return for Arab recognition.
- Bar Lev Line:** Heavily fortified Israeli sand-rampart defensive chain built along the east bank of the Suez Canal after 1967.

KEY TOPIC 3 (Part 1): Diplomatic Negotiations: From Shuttle Diplomacy to Camp David, 1974–1979

KEY TOPIC

3A

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Lesson KT 3.1 • Yasser Arafat at the UN, Kissinger's Shuttle Diplomacy & The Egypt–Israel Peace Treaty

EXAM TERMINOLOGY VAULT:

- Shuttle Diplomacy
- Yasser Arafat at UN
- Anwar Sadat
- Knesset Address
- Menachem Begin
- Jimmy Carter
- Camp David Accords
- Sinai Demilitarisation
- Arab League Boycott

13 November 1974

DIPLOMATIC LEGITIMACY OF THE PLO

Yasser Arafat Addresses the UN General Assembly

- TRIGGER: Arab League summit at Rabat recognized the PLO as the "sole legitimate representative of the Palestinian people".
- ACTION: Arafat addressed the UN wearing a holster: *"Do not let the olive branch fall from my hand."* The UN granted the PLO observer status.
- CONSEQUENCE: Elevated the Palestinian national cause from a mere refugee issue into a recognized global political struggle for statehood.



Yasser Arafat delivering his famous address...

1974–1975

STEP-BY-STEP DIPLOMATIC REALISM

Kissinger's "Shuttle Diplomacy" & Sinai Disengagement

- TRIGGER: The terrifying superpower nuclear alert during the Yom Kippur War convinced Washington that regional stability was a vital US priority.
- ACTION: US Secretary of State Henry Kissinger flew relentlessly between Cairo, Tel Aviv, and Damascus negotiating military disengagement pacts.
- CONSEQUENCE: Separated Israeli and Egyptian armies along the Suez Canal, reopened the canal to shipping, and detached Egypt from the Soviet sphere of influence.



Israeli armor returning during the US-negotiate...

19–20 November 1977

THE PSYCHOLOGICAL BREAKTHROUGH

President Anwar Sadat's Historic Journey to Jerusalem

- TRIGGER: Sadat realized that Egypt's fragile economy could no longer sustain war, and that only peace could recover the oil-rich Sinai Peninsula.
- ACTION: Sadat made the electrifying announcement that he was ready to travel to the heart of Israel; he addressed the Knesset, recognizing Israel's existence.
- CONSEQUENCE: Demolished the 30-year psychological wall of mutual hatred, paving the way for direct bilateral negotiations hosted by US President Jimmy Carter.



Anwar Sadat addressing the Israeli Parliament...

5–17 September 1978

THE HISTORIC FRAMEWORK FOR PEACE

The Camp David Accords

- TRIGGER: Talks stalled over Israeli withdrawal from Sinai settlements and Palestinian autonomy in the West Bank and Gaza.
- ACTION: President Carter isolated Begin and Sadat for 13 intense days at Camp David, drafting the **Framework for Peace in the Middle East**.
- CONSEQUENCE: Agreed on full Israeli withdrawal from Sinai in return for Egyptian diplomatic recognition, but left Palestinian autonomy vague and unfulfilled.



Menachem Begin, Jimmy Carter, and Anwar Sada...

26 March 1979

THE FIRST ARAB-ISRAELI PEACE TREATY

The Washington Treaty: Egypt–Israel Peace Treaty Signed

- TRIGGER: Final legal formalization of the Camp David Accords backed by billions of dollars in US economic and military aid to both nations.
- ACTION: Sadat and Begin signed the formal peace treaty in Washington, establishing diplomatic relations and trade ties.
- CONSEQUENCE: Israel neutralized its most formidable military opponent; the Arab League expelled Egypt, relocated its headquarters to Tunis, and Sadat was assassinated in 1981.



The historic three-way handshake between...

KEY SPECIFICATION GLOSSARY:

- Shuttle Diplomacy:** Intense mediation involving travelling back and forth between rival capitals without direct face-to-face talks.
- Knesset:** The unicameral national parliament and legislative assembly of the State of Israel in Jerusalem.
- Camp David Accords:** 1978 peace agreements brokered by Jimmy Carter leading to the first Arab–Israeli peace treaty.
- Normalisation:** Establishing standard diplomatic, commercial, cultural, and travel relations between formerly hostile nations.

KEY TOPIC 3 (Part 2): The Palestinian Issue, The 1982 Lebanon War & Attempts at a Solution to 1995

KEY TOPIC

3B

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Lessons KT 3.2 & KT 3.3 • Operation Peace for Galilee, Sabra & Shatila, First Intifada & The Oslo Accords

EXAM TERMINOLOGY VAULT:

- Operation Peace for Galilee
- Ariel Sharon
- Sabra & Shatila
- Kahan Commission
- First Intifada
- UNLU
- Oslo Accords
- Declaration of Principles
- Palestinian Authority
- Oslo II (Areas A, B, C)
- Yitzhak Rabin Assassination

June – Sept 1982

THE WAR OF CHOICE & PLO EXPULSION

The 1982 Lebanon War (Operation Peace for Galilee)

- TRIGGER:**Assassination attempt on Israeli ambassador Shlomo Argov in London by the Abu Nidal faction; ongoing cross-border PLO rocket attacks from southern Lebanon.
- ACTION:**Defence Minister **Ariel Sharon** launched a full-scale invasion, advancing 60 miles north to surround and besiege the PLO leadership in West Beirut.
- CONSEQUENCE:**US-negotiated ceasefire evacuated 14,000 PLO fighters by sea to Tunis; shattered PLO military presence on Israel's northern border, but entangled IDF in Lebanon.



16–18 September 1982

MORAL CRISIS & ISRAELI DOMESTIC TURMOIL

The Sabra and Shatila Massacre & The Kahan Commission

- TRIGGER:**Assassination of newly elected Lebanese Christian President Bachir Gemayel by Syrian-backed agents.
- ACTION:**IDF permitted Christian Phalangist militia into the Sabra and Shatila refugee camps; Phalangists slaughtered up to 3,500 unarmed Palestinian refugees.
- CONSEQUENCE:**Huge anti-war protests (400,000 in Tel Aviv); Israel's **Kahan Commission** ruled Sharon bore "personal responsibility" for failing to prevent the slaughter, forcing his resignation.



December 1987

GRASSROOTS PALESTINIAN MASS RESISTANCE

Outbreak of the First Intifada (The Uprising of the Stones)

- TRIGGER:**An Israeli military tank transport crashed into civilian cars at Jabalya Refugee Camp in Gaza, killing four Palestinian workers.
- ACTION:**Spontaneous mass protests, strikes, boycotts, and stone-throwing erupted across Gaza and the West Bank, coordinated by the local **UNLU** (not Tunis PLO).
- CONSEQUENCE:**IDF policy of "force, might, and beatings" drew global media condemnation; convinced Israeli military leaders like Yitzhak Rabin that occupation could not be maintained by force.



13 September 1993

HISTORIC MUTUAL RECOGNITION

The Oslo Accords (Declaration of Principles)

- TRIGGER:**Secret back-channel talks in Oslo, Norway, enabled direct face-to-face bargaining between Israeli diplomats and PLO representatives.
- ACTION:**Signed the **Declaration of Principles**: Israel and PLO officially recognized each other; established the **Palestinian National Authority (PA)** for interim self-rule in Gaza and Jericho.
- CONSEQUENCE:**Historic psychological breakthrough; rejected by extremist factions on both sides (Hamas and Islamic Jihad launched suicide bombings; Israeli settlers protested).



October 1994

CONSOLIDATING REGIONAL PEACE

The Israel-Jordan Peace Treaty

- TRIGGER:**The momentum generated by the Oslo Accords created diplomatic cover for King Hussein of Jordan to formalize relations with Israel.
- ACTION:**Yitzhak Rabin and King Hussein signed the second full peace treaty between Israel and an Arab state, settling border and water disputes.
- CONSEQUENCE:**Solidified Israel's longest eastern frontier, opened bilateral trade and security cooperation, and isolated hardline rejectionist states like Syria and Iraq.

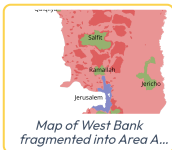


1995

PARTITION OF THE WEST BANK & THE TRAGIC CLIMAX

The Oslo II Agreement & The Assassination of Yitzhak Rabin

- TRIGGER:**Need to expand Palestinian civil self-rule beyond Jericho into major West Bank Palestinian towns.
- ACTION:**Oslo II partitioned the West Bank into **Areas A, B, and C**. On 4 November 1995, Prime Minister **Yitzhak Rabin** was assassinated by right-wing Jewish extremist Yigal Amir.
- CONSEQUENCE:**West Bank remained fragmented under 60% direct Israeli military control (Area C); the peace process lost its principal Israeli architect, plunging the peace movement into crisis.



KEY SPECIFICATION GLOSSARY:

Intifada: Arabic for "shaking off": the mass Palestinian grassroots uprising against Israeli occupation (1987–1993).

UNLU: Unified National Leadership of the Uprising: the clandestine local leadership that coordinated strikes and protests during the Intifada.

Palestinian Authority: Interim administrative governing body established under the 1993 Oslo Accords to govern parts of the West Bank and Gaza.

Areas A, B, and C: The 1995 territorial partition of the West Bank into Palestinian civil/security (A), Palestinian civil/Israeli security (B), and full Israeli control (C).